
WHAT IT TAKES, WHAT IT CANNOT, WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

The parts of your PM job AI actually takes

The panic is aimed at the wrong thing. AI is not coming for the job. It is coming for a specific list of tasks, and that list was never what made you valuable.

Here is the honest split: five things it takes, what it cannot touch in each one, and what to do with the time you get back.

1 It writes the ticket. It does not decide the ticket matters.

Requirements, acceptance criteria, the whole user story. It drafts them faster than you and the first pass is usually fine.

What it cannot do is tell you whether that work should exist. It has no view on your roadmap, no memory of the thing you tried last year that failed, and no stake in the outcome.

EXAMPLE

Let it write the first draft of every ticket this sprint. Spend the time you saved deciding which two of them you would cut if you had to cut two.

WHY THIS MATTERS: the writing was never the scarce part. Choosing was.

2 It drafts the doc in thirty seconds. It cannot sit in the room.

You will get a clean PRD faster than you can open the template. Structure, headings, edge cases you might have missed.

Then two directors want opposite things and one of them outranks you. That meeting is the job. No tool attends it for you, and no document wins it.

EXAMPLE

Generate the draft, then spend your prep time on one question instead: what does each person in that room actually need to hear to say yes.

WHY THIS MATTERS: alignment is not a document problem. It never was.

3 It reads two hundred interviews. It cannot tell you who to believe.

Synthesis at that volume used to take a week. Now it takes an afternoon, and the themes it pulls out are real themes.

But your loudest customer and your most important customer are usually not the same person, and no summary knows which is which. That call is judgment, and judgment is built from context the model does not have.

EXAMPLE

Take the themes it gives you and rank them by revenue at stake rather than by how often they came up. The ranking will change.

WHY THIS MATTERS: frequency is not importance. Confusing the two is how teams build the wrong thing very efficiently.

4 It builds the deck. It does not own the number.

Slides, narrative arc, a chart you would have spent an hour formatting.

Then the number is wrong in front of leadership, and the person answering for it is you. That does not transfer. You get the blame without the authority in this job, and a tool does not change who is standing there.

EXAMPLE

Before you present anything it generated, find the one number you would be least able to defend if someone pushed. Go verify that one yourself.

WHY THIS MATTERS: accountability is the part of the role that cannot be delegated, to a person or to anything else.

5 It makes you faster where you are strong and dangerous where you are not.

This is the one nobody says out loud. It amplifies whatever you already have.

A PM who understands the system uses it to move quicker through work they could already check. A PM who does not understand the system now ships confident answers they cannot evaluate. Same tool, opposite outcome.

EXAMPLE

Pick one area you have been treating as a black box. Use the tool to ask basic questions about it until you could explain it to someone else without help.

WHY THIS MATTERS: the gap between people who can check the output and people who cannot is about to become the whole difference.

None of the five things it takes were the reason anyone valued you. They were the overhead attached to the reason.

The work that is left is choosing, aligning, judging, and owning it. That was always the job. Most of us just never had the time to do it properly.